



Free template

The Business Travel Policy Template for Growing Companies

A complete travel and expense policy you can edit, with a one-page rollout checklist. Written for US companies of 300 to 1,500 people.



How to use this template

- 1. Read it once as a traveler would.** Every rule should answer a question someone asks when booking.
- 2. Set the numbers with finance.** The suggested starting points are common choices for a US company of this size. Change each one to fit your budget, routes and cities.
- 3. Keep what fits, cut what does not.** A shorter policy that people follow beats a longer one they skip.
- 4. Name the owner and approver.** Section 1 sets who owns the policy and who approves changes.
- 5. Set it up where people book.** The limits work best when the booking tool shows each option as in or out of policy.
- 6. Roll it out with the checklist.** The last page is a one-page plan for the first 30 days.

In this template, "the company" means the employer adopting the policy, and "traveler" means anyone traveling on the company's business.

1 Purpose, scope and ownership

Purpose. This policy helps our people travel safely and comfortably for work, and helps the company spend on travel with care. It sets out how to book, what the company pays for, how to claim expenses and how you get your money back.

Who it covers. Employees and contractors who travel on company business, and guests whose travel the company pays for.

Ownership. The Head of Operations owns this policy. The CFO approves changes to limits and approval rules. Questions go to the policy owner.

Principle. Spend the company's money as you would spend your own on a business trip: on what the work needs, at a fair price.

2 How to book

Book flights and hotels through the company booking tool. It shows every option as in or out of policy, applies the right budget and code, and gives you help when plans change.

Complex trips. Group travel, events and trips with more than three destinations can be booked with the help of the policy owner.

Booking for others. Assistants and office admins may book on behalf of the people they support. The same rules apply.

Bookings made elsewhere. If you book outside the company tool, add the reason when you submit the expense. Repeated bookings outside the tool are reviewed with your manager.

3 Approvals

Trips inside this policy book straight away.

Approval is needed before booking for:

- Any flight, hotel or cost outside the limits in this policy
- International trips
- Trips with a total estimated cost above \$3,000
- Travel for guests and candidates

Who approves. Your budget owner. If your budget owner is traveling with you, their manager approves.

Add a reason. Every approval request includes the business reason and, for exceptions, why the in-policy option does not work.

4 Flights

Rule	Suggested starting point
Cabin class	Economy for flights under 6 hours; premium economy for flights of 6 hours or more
Business class	For flights over 10 hours, with approval
Fare	The lowest logical fare: a reasonable departure time and up to one stop more than the fastest option
Booking window	Book domestic flights 14 days ahead and international flights 21 days ahead where the trip allows
Bags and seats	One checked bag and standard seat selection are covered
Loyalty programs	Travelers may keep personal miles and points; loyalty never decides the choice of flight

5 Hotels

Rule	Suggested starting point
Nightly limit, standard cities	Up to \$250 a night
Nightly limit, high-cost cities (for example New York, San Francisco, Boston, Washington DC)	Up to \$375 a night
International	Set by city with the policy owner
Event hotels	Allowed above the limit when booked for a conference or client event; add the reason when booking
Long stays	Stays of 7 nights or more can use serviced apartments at or below the nightly limit
Room type	A standard room; upgrades are a personal cost

6 Ground transport

Rule	Suggested starting point
Rideshare and taxis	Standard options to and from airports, hotels and business locations
Rental cars	Midsize or smaller, when cheaper or more practical than rideshare; decline extra insurance covered by the company's policy
Rail	Standard class; business class for journeys over 3 hours
Personal car	Mileage at the IRS standard rate for the year of travel
Parking and tolls	Covered with a receipt

7 Meals and entertainment

Rule	Suggested starting point
Daily meal limit, standard cities	Up to \$75 a day at actual cost
Daily meal limit, high-cost cities	Up to \$100 a day at actual cost
Client meals	Approved by the budget owner; list attendees and the business purpose
Alcohol	Reasonable amounts with client meals only
Team meals while traveling	Paid by the most senior person present

8 When plans change

Delays and cancellations. When a flight is delayed or canceled, use the company booking tool first. It shows what happened and your new options. Confirm the one that suits you.

Changes you choose. Change a booking through the company tool, so the change and any fare difference are recorded.

Unused tickets. If you cancel a flight, the ticket value is recorded against your name. Use it on your next trip before it expires.

Travel help. If the booking tool cannot solve the problem, call the policy owner during business hours, or your manager outside them. Your safety comes first: book what you need to get somewhere safe, and explain afterwards.

9 Paying for travel

Corporate card. Use your corporate card for flights, hotels and ground transport. Keep personal spending off it. If a personal charge lands on the card by mistake, flag it within five business days.

Personal card. If you have no corporate card, use a personal card and claim the cost as an expense.

Cash advances. Available for international trips where cards are not widely accepted, with approval.

10 Expenses and receipts

What the company pays for. The costs in sections 4 to 7, plus business calls, internet while traveling, visas and required vaccinations for the trip.

What the company does not pay for. Personal items, upgrades you choose, fines, in-room entertainment, and personal days added to a trip.

Receipts. Upload an itemized receipt for every expense, during the trip where possible. A valid receipt shows the merchant, date, items and amount paid. For a lost receipt, submit a short written statement with the same details.

Deadline. Submit expenses within 30 days of the end of the trip. Claims older than 90 days need approval from finance.

Coding. Every trip is coded to a cost center and GL code before booking. Finance sets the codes.

Review. Your manager approves your expenses. They check that each item has a business purpose, sits inside this policy and has a receipt.

11 Reimbursement

Approved expenses are paid in the next payment run after approval. Mileage is paid at the IRS standard rate for the year of travel.

12 Exceptions and review

Exceptions. Your budget owner may approve an exception before you book. Exceptions after the fact go to finance.

Misuse. Claims that break this policy may be declined, and repeated misuse is handled under the company's code of conduct.

Review. The policy owner reviews this policy twice a year, and after any big change in how the company travels. Changes are recorded in the change log below.

Version	Date	Change	Approved by
1.0	Date of adoption	Policy adopted	CFO

Rollout checklist: the first 30 days

Week 1: agree the numbers

- ☐ Flight, hotel and meal limits agreed with finance
 - ☐ Approval threshold and approvers agreed
 - ☐ Cost centers and GL codes for travel confirmed
 - ☐ Policy owner and approver of changes named in section 1
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Week 2: set it up

- ☐ Limits and approval rules set up in the booking tool
 - ☐ Travelers, assistants and approvers added
 - ☐ Corporate cards added in payment settings
 - ☐ One test trip booked inside policy and one outside it, followed to the approver
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Week 3: announce it

- ☐ Approvers briefed on what will reach them
 - ☐ One message to everyone who travels: where to book, the three limits people ask about most, who to ask
 - ☐ Policy saved where people look for it, with a link in the booking tool
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Week 4: check it

- ☐ Questions collected from the first two weeks
 - ☐ First month-end reviewed: bookings outside the tool, exceptions, missing receipts
 - ☐ Three rules that caused the most questions rewritten
 - ☐ Next review date set, six months out
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About Mirae

Mirae is business travel and expense software. Your people book flights and hotels inside company policy, and finance sees every trip with its budget and GL code. Every option is marked in or out of policy, approvals only come in when something is out of policy, and when plans change your traveler gets an alert and new options to confirm. Signing up and onboarding are free, at any company size: we set up your company, your travel policy and your people with you. Mirae is built by Tabhi, the company behind the Monde travel marketplace. mirae.ai